The Imprint House

Project brief — everything discussed so far (as of 1 November 2026). Hand-off document for continuing in Claude Code.

1. Project overview

A family business (based in Ajmer, Rajasthan) has bought a laser marking machine and is building a new brand for bulk B2B branded gifting: engraved metal keychains, bottles, pens and similar items, sourced, engraved and delivered in full packaging. A UV printer may be added later if this works.

Important: this project is completely separate from Havels Group / Softies and from any of its Shopify stores, accounts or assets. Never build on or change a Havels-connected store.

2. Decisions locked so far

Topic	Decision
Brand name	The Imprint House (chosen, "mostly" final). Use with a descriptive tagline, e.g. "The Imprint House — Engraved Corporate Gifts".
Existing page gifthub53	Do not rebrand it into the B2B brand. Start a new brand. Keep gifthub53 for personal/retail gifting if it brings orders (or archive and rename only if it has real local business followers).
Business model	Level 2+: source products, engrave in-house, deliver fully packaged. Not plain engraving job work.
Target	Small and mid-size businesses first (shops, clinics, cafés, schools, dealerships, startups, offices), corporates later. Scale up gradually.
Pricing	Price is not a constraint (e.g. metal pen ~Rs 80, metal keychain ~Rs 30). Use low prices to open doors, but do not make price the brand message.
Samples	Free sample with the client's logo is a core offer.
UV machine	Do not buy yet. Test demand first by outsourcing colour jobs (see section 7).
Website platform	Shopify, set up as a quote-led store (not a normal cart-first shop). A new Shopify account has been created with a separate email.
Website look	Clean and minimal: white and light grey. Auto-generated Shopify previews were judged too basic — to be refined with real photos, a better theme and useful interactive features.

3. Market analysis (summary)

Is the market dead? No. Demand is real and shifting from Diwali-only gifting to year-round gifting (onboarding, rewards, dealer meets, client gifts). Personalisation is now expected. Market-size figures online disagree widely, so do not rely on them; the direction (steady growth, more personalisation, year-round orders) is consistent.

Competition: very high nationally/online at the cheap end (IndiaMART-style listings, very low per-piece prices; big players like Giftlaya, InstaCuppa, Oranjbox). Locally in Ajmer, no strong B2B laser-gifting players showed up in searches (needs on-ground verification). Small local businesses likely order from Jaipur/Delhi or through print shops that outsource.

Real risks (bigger than competition): price wars at the bottom, seasonality, and the need for active, in-person selling.

Timing: Diwali 2026 corporate orders are already placed. Next windows: December year-end/New Year client gifts, wedding season (to February), financial year-end dealer meets and awards (February–March).

4. Competition levels (where to play)

Level	What it is	Competition
1. Logo on item	Plain logo on a standard item, sold on price	Very high
2. Complete gift solution	Product + engraving + packaging + delivery + GST invoice	Medium — this is where the business already is
3. Personal names	Each recipient's name engraved, plus company logo	Low
4. Industry packages	Repeat-order solutions built for one industry	Very low locally
5. Premium curated sets	Designed executive gift boxes	Low, but needs capital and taste — later goal

Strategy: operate at Level 2 and add Levels 3 and 4 on top (no new machinery needed). Example Level 4 offer: for a car dealership, a metal keychain engraved with each customer's car number plus the dealership logo, in a branded box, delivered weekly from their delivery list — a monthly repeat order.

What less-crowded players do differently: sell a result not an item; remove risk (mockups, samples, guaranteed dates); build relationships for repeat orders; choose a focus; offer ready packages by budget.

5. Positioning and brand story

Core line: "Branded gifts, engraved in-house and delivered ready to give."

Three promises: (1) See it before you pay — free sample with your logo. (2) Made in our own workshop — no outsourcing, so quality and timing are in our control. (3) Ready to hand over — packaged, labelled, delivered on time.

Unique position: local and personal like a neighbourhood shop, in-house and reliable like a big gifting company.

Brand story draft: A family business from Ajmer. We brought a precision laser in-house because branded gifts kept fading, peeling and getting thrown away. Engraving doesn't fade — it's cut into the metal. Every piece is made in our own workshop, checked by family, and sampled before you commit. (Add one real detail about who in the family runs it and why.)

SMB-friendly wording: avoid heavy "corporate gifting solutions" language. Use lines like "Branded gifts for your business — starting from 25 pieces" and "For shops, clinics, cafés, schools, dealerships, startups and offices."

6. Target customers

- Car and bike dealerships — keychain with every delivery (monthly repeat)
- Real estate developers — engraved key tags at flat handover
- Hotels and resorts in Ajmer and Pushkar — key tags, guest souvenirs
- Schools and coaching institutes — awards, farewell gifts with student names
- Clinics, hospitals, pharma distributors — pens and desk items

- Industry clusters: Kishangarh marble traders, Bhilwara textile companies — dealer meets, client gifts
- Wedding planners — bulk return gifts (wedding season)
- Shops, cafés, startups and small offices

7. Sales plan, operations and UV

Sales channels (Instagram is the portfolio, not the sales engine)

- Direct outreach with a physical sample bearing the prospect's logo — highest-converting move
- Google Business Profile (e.g. "corporate gifts near me", "logo engraving Ajmer")
- IndiaMART / TradeIndia — list a few premium products, avoid the cheapest categories
- LinkedIn company page plus founder posts aimed at HR/admin managers
- WhatsApp Business catalogue for quotes and repeat orders

30-day test (before more investment)

Pick 30 local businesses across 2 industries (dealerships as one). Build one complete package per industry, deliver a free logo sample in person with a simple price sheet, and track conversions. If 4–5 order and 1–2 show signs of reordering, the business is working.

Operating rules

- Take at least 50% advance on bulk orders; full advance from first-time clients
- Keep a backup supplier for the top 5 products
- Price every package with packaging included
- Get written approval of name lists before engraving individual names
- Check machine type: fiber lasers excel on metal but are weak on wood, glass and many plastics — don't promise what the machine can't do well

UV printer decision

UV adds full-colour logos (laser is single-colour) and glass, acrylic, plastic, diary covers and phone cases. But cost varies hugely (big-brand machines are a major investment; cheaper Chinese desktop models vary in quality and service), and UV is also getting crowded. Test first: take colour-logo orders and outsource them to a UV print shop in Ajmer/Jaipur with a margin. If several such orders come in each month for 2–3 months, buying UV is justified.

8. Ready packages (to build)

Create 3 fully packaged, photographed packages, e.g. under Rs 300, under Rs 600 and under Rs 1,200 per person. These will anchor the website, sample visits and first Instagram posts. Optional tier naming: Essential / Executive / Signature. Pending: current product list with rough prices.

9. Name exploration history

Earlier options considered: Mohar & Co., Signet Studio, Markwell, Imprint & Co., Brandwell, Keepmark, Marque & Co., Etched & Co., Mark & Merit and others. Removed by owner: Wellmade Gifting, Seal & Co., Giftwell Studio. Note: "Markwell" is used by a registered Delhi chit-fund company. Final pick: The Imprint House. No Indian gifting business with this exact name was found, but "imprint" is common in the print/publishing world, so a clear tagline is needed. Still to verify: Instagram handle availability and a trademark check (class 40 covers engraving services).

10. Domain status

theimprinthouse.com is taken. Shopify showed .net, .shop, .store and .org versions as available at the time of checking (availability can change). Recommendation: first check theimprinthouse.in on GoDaddy/Hostinger (not checked by the Shopify tool) and connect it to Shopify; otherwise choose .shop or .net. Set up a domain email (e.g. hello@theimprinthouse.in).

11. Website plan

Structure (quote-led Shopify store)

- Hero: close-up video of laser engraving + headline + "Get a free sample" and "Request a quote" buttons
- How it works: send logo → free mockup in 24 hrs → physical sample → bulk order
- Ready packages by budget
- Product catalogue with "starting from Rs X" pricing; small orders/paid samples can use checkout
- "Who we work with": one tile per business type with a matching gift idea
- Brand story, trust details (GST, workshop photos), quote form, one-tap WhatsApp on every page

Useful interactive features (help buyers decide; avoid heavy animations)

- "See your logo on it" — upload logo, preview on product (personaliser app or a mockup-request form at first)
- Budget package picker — budget per person + quantity → suggested packages
- Quantity price calculator — price per piece drops as quantity rises
- One-tap WhatsApp

Photo shoot list (phone + daylight + white sheet is enough to start)

- Close-up video of engraving in action
- Each product on white / light grey
- Products in boxes, open and closed
- In-use shots: bottle on office desk, keychain with car keys, pen on notebook

Theme: free Shopify themes are basic; choose a stronger paid theme from the Shopify Theme Store once real photos exist.

Creatives / social content ideas

- Laser engraving close-up reels
- Before/after: blank to branded
- "One bottle, 50 different names"
- Budget-led posts for business owners, e.g. "Staff gift under Rs 600"

12. Open items and next steps

#	Action	Owner
1	Share current product list with rough prices (keychains, bottles, pens, boxes)	Business
2	Confirm machine type (fiber or other) and materials it handles well	Business
3	Register domain (check .in first) and Instagram handle	Business
4	Claim/set up the new, separate Shopify store; confirm store name before any edits	Business + Claude

#	Action	Owner
5	Build interactive homepage preview / blueprint with real products and prices	Claude
6	Do the photo shoot	Business
7	Build 3 budget packages	Business + Claude
8	Run the 30-day sample outreach test	Business

Note: market figures and competitor details came from public web sources at the time of discussion and should be re-verified before being used in any external material.